SUPERSTORE SALES ANALYTICS

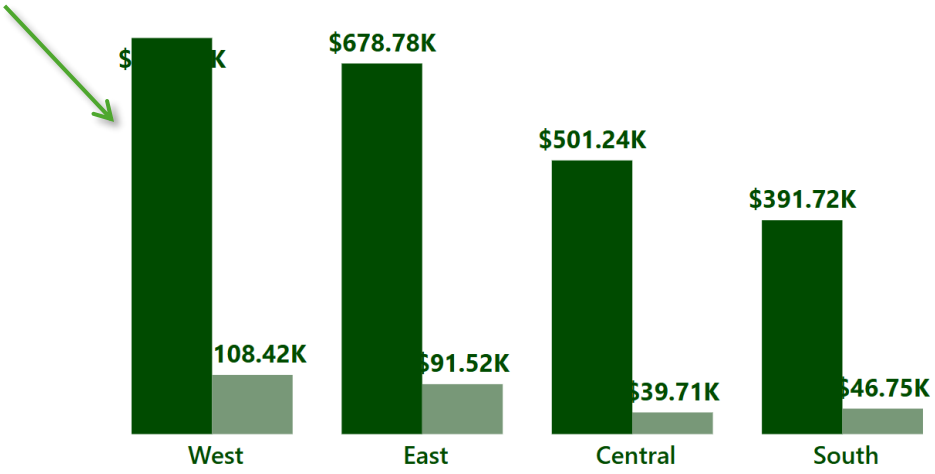
Executive Summary

Project Overview

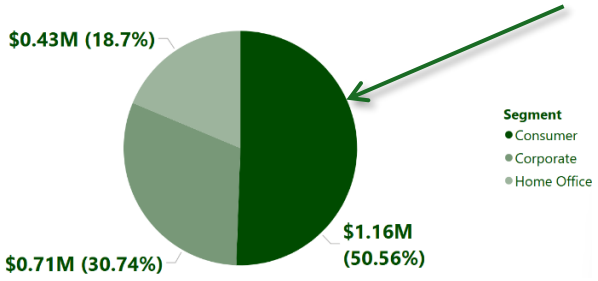
This project focused on analyzing the Superstore dataset using Microsoft Power BI to evaluate sales performance, profitability, customer segments, product categories, and sales trends over time. The dashboard was developed to answer six key business questions and provide insights that can support data-driven decision-making.

Key Findings

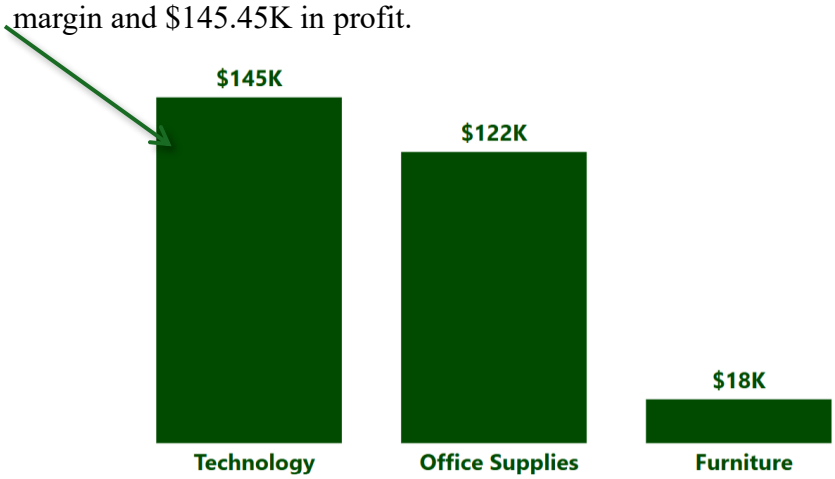
- **Regional performance:** The West region generated the highest sales and profit, with $725.46K in sales and $108.42K in profit, followed by the East region, with $678.78K in sales and $91.52K in profit.



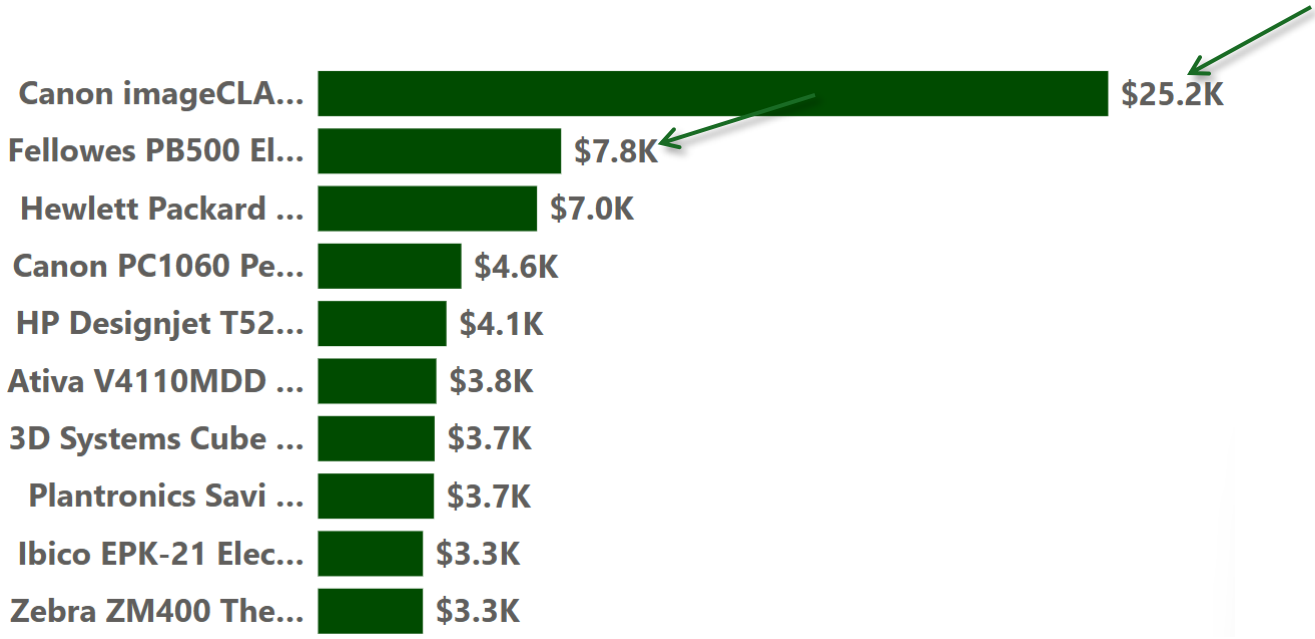
- **Customer segment performance:** The Consumer segment generated the highest revenue of $1.16M, accounting for 50.56% of total revenue.



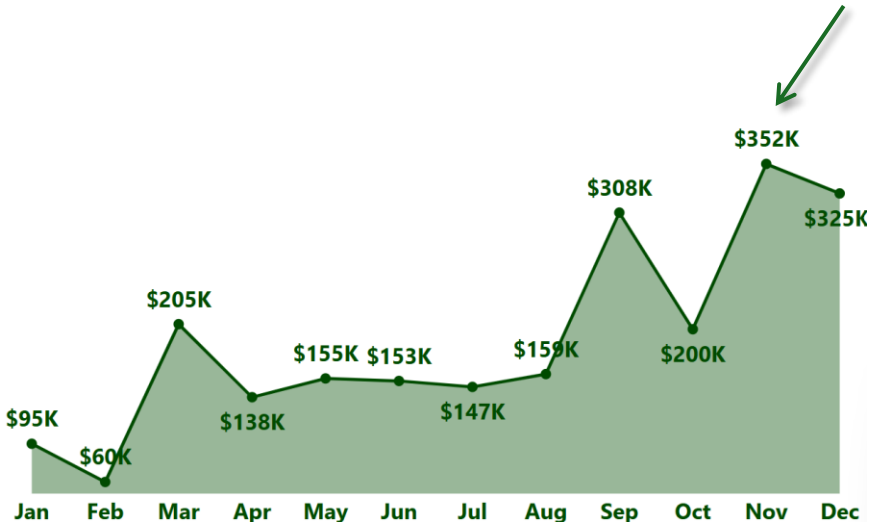
- **Category performance**: Technology is the most profitable category, with a 17% profit margin and $145.45K in profit.



- **Product performance:** The Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier is the most profitable product, with a 41% profit margin, $61.60K in sales, and $25.20K in profit. It is followed by the Fellowes PB500 Electric Punch Plastic Comb Binding Machine, with a 28% profit margin, $27.45K in sales, and $7.25K in profit.

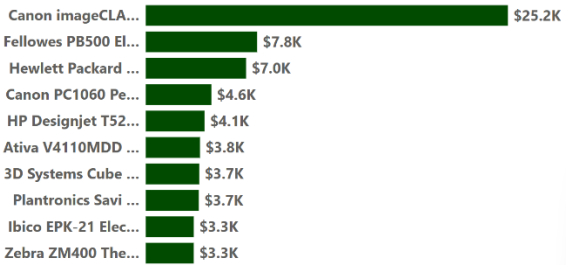


- **Sales trends:** November recorded the highest sales, generating $352.46K in revenue.

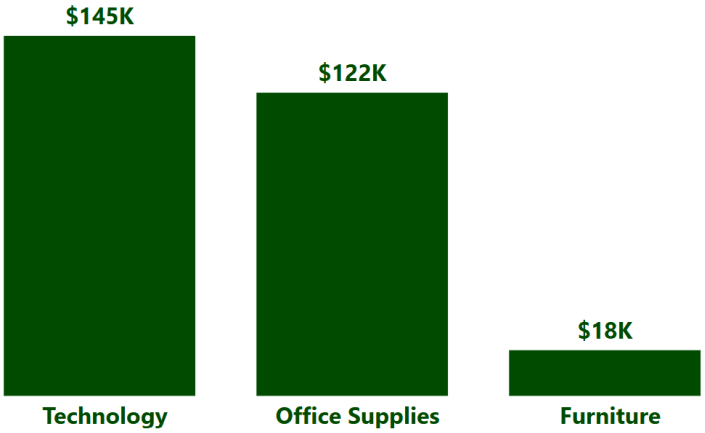


Business Opportunities

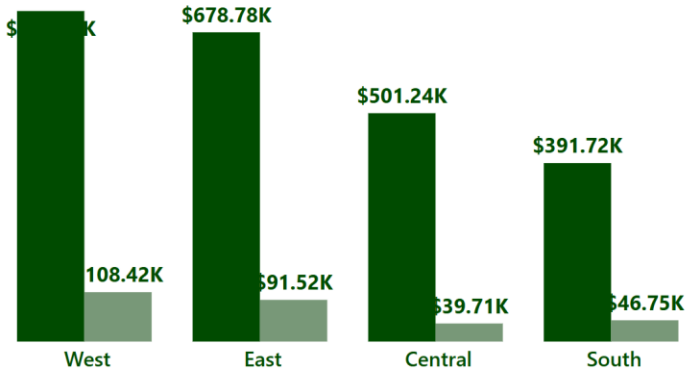
Focus on high-profit products: Management should focus more on the Canon image CLASS 2200 Advanced Copier because of its high profit margin and contribution to overall profit.



Invest in the Technology category: Management should invest more in the Technology category because it has the highest profit margin of 17%, creating an opportunity to improve overall profitability.

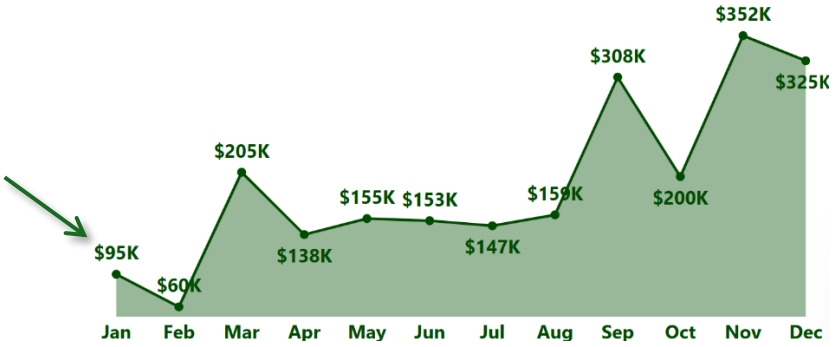


Expand successful regional strategies: Management should study the strategies used in the West region, which generated the highest sales and profit, and apply similar approaches in other regions to improve performance.

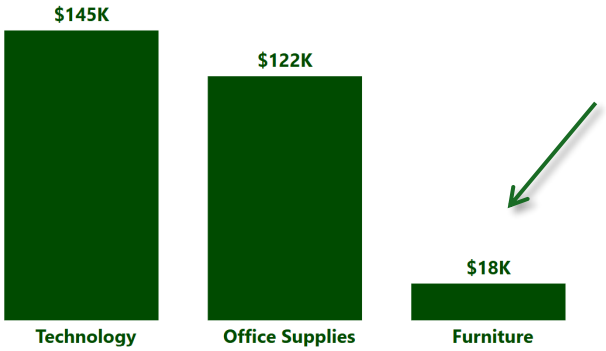


Business Risk

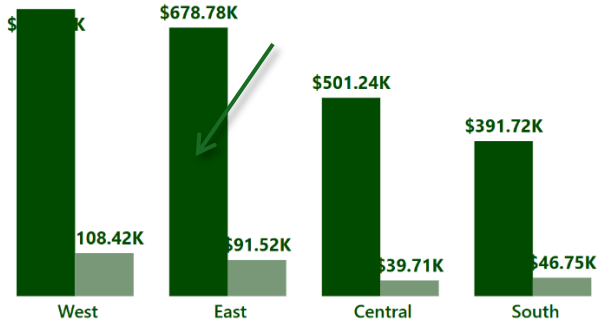
- **Low January sales:** January recorded the lowest revenue of $94.92K, with a total order of 178 orders. Management should investigate the reasons for the low sales and develop strategies to improve performance during this period.



- **Low furniture profitability:** The Furniture category generated $18.45K in profit, with a profit margin of just 2%. This indicates that the category may be facing high costs, excessive discounts, or pricing challenges.

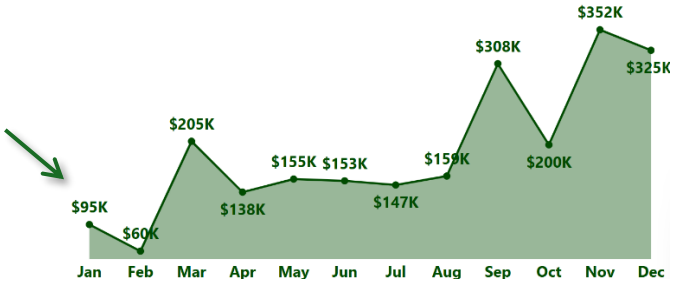


- **Low Central region profitability:** The Central region has a profit margin of 8% despite generating substantial revenue. Management should investigate whether low margin products, high operating costs, or excessive discounts are affecting profitability.

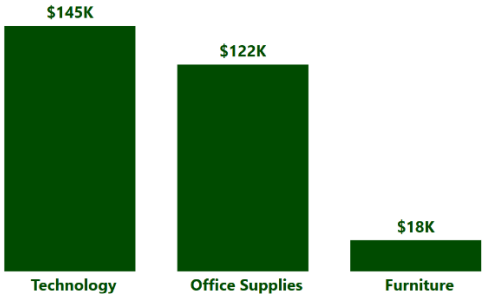


Recommendations

- **Improve January sales performance:** Management should introduce targeted promotions, discounts on selected products, and marketing campaigns in January to attract more customers and increase order volume.

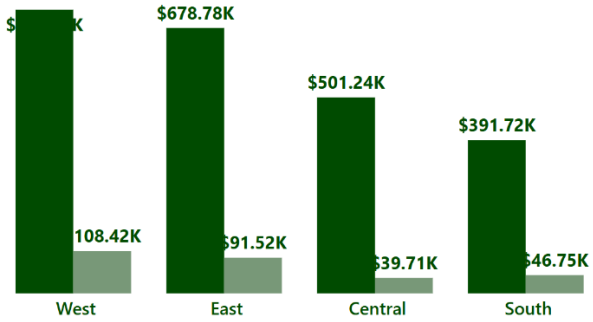


- **Review Furniture pricing and costs:** Management should investigate the reasons for the low profit margin in the Furniture category and review product pricing, supplier costs, and discount policies to improve profitability.

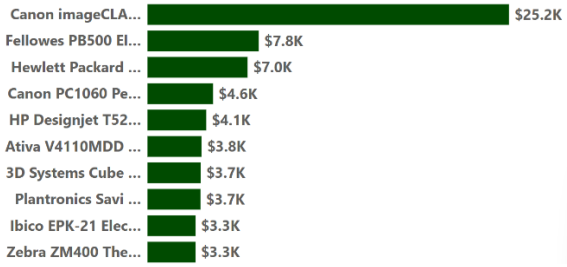


- **Improve Central region profitability:** Management should analyze product-level profit margins, operating costs, and discount rates in the Central region. The focus should be on

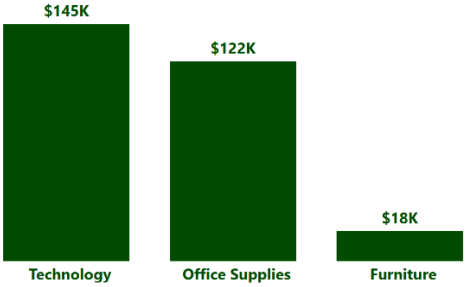
promoting high-margin products and reducing unnecessary costs rather than simply increasing sales.



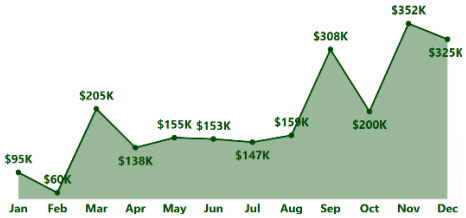
- **Prioritize high-performing products:** Management should ensure adequate stock of the Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier and evaluate opportunities to increase its sales while maintaining its profit margin.



- **Increase investment in Technology:** Management should consider expanding its Technology product offerings, improving product availability, and promoting high-margin products to increase profits.



- **Plan ahead for November demand:** Management should prepare for the December sales peak by optimizing inventory levels, planning marketing campaigns early, and ensuring that popular products are available to meet customer demand.



Conclusion

The analysis demonstrates the importance of evaluating both sales revenue and profitability when assessing business performance. By addressing low-margin areas, investing in profitable products, and monitoring monthly and regional performance, management can identify opportunities to improve profitability and make more informed business decisions.